AGENDA

FOOD SECURITY SUMMITX DUBAI 2026

DATE: 6TH & 7TH MAY 2026

VENUE: DUBAI

VISIT: WWW.FOODSECURITYSUMMITX.COM

PRESENTED BY:
VERTALISX

WE CATER TO

FOOD SECURITY SUMMITX

- **Agri-Inputs (Seeds, Fertilisers, Crop Protection, BioAg)**

Seeds

1. *Hybrid seeds: specially bred for higher yield, uniformity, and resilience.*
2. *Vegetable/cereal/fruit seeds: core segment in GCC (tomatoes, cucumbers, maize, dates).*
3. *Drought/salinity tolerant seeds: essential in arid UAE conditions.*
4. *CRISPR/edited seeds: advanced genetic tech to develop resistant varieties.*
5. *Seed banks: institutions storing germplasm, critical for food security.*

Fertilisers

1. *NPK blends: traditional nitrogen, phosphorus, potassium fertilisers.*
2. *Controlled/slow-release: efficiency fertilisers that release nutrients gradually.*
3. *Nano fertilisers: ultra-small particles for faster plant absorption.*
4. *Biofertilisers: microbial solutions that improve soil fertility.*
5. *Foliar feeds: liquid nutrients sprayed directly on leaves.*

Crop Protection

1. *Biopesticides: natural pest control agents.*
2. *IPM (Integrated Pest Management): combining biological, cultural, and chemical methods.*
3. *Seed treatments: coating seeds with fungicides/pesticides for early protection.*
4. *Fungicides/herbicides/nematicides: chemicals for disease, weed, and pest control.*
5. *Pheromone traps: eco-friendly insect monitoring/control tools.*

Soil & Microbiome Solutions

1. *Bioinoculants: beneficial bacteria and fungi to promote plant health.*
2. *Mycorrhiza: symbiotic fungi improving nutrient and water uptake.*
3. *Compost accelerators: agents to speed up organic waste decomposition.*
4. *Regenerative amendments: humic/fulvic acids, carbon-based products improving soil.*

- **Water & Irrigation (Desalination, Smart Irrigation, Fertigation)**

Drip & Micro Irrigation

1. *Systems that deliver water directly to roots, reducing wastage.*
2. *Includes drippers, emitters, micro sprinklers.*

Precision Irrigation Controllers

1. *IoT-enabled devices automating irrigation schedules.*
2. *Weather-based controllers adjust watering in real-time.*

Fertigation Systems

1. *Equipment mixing fertilisers with irrigation water.*
2. *Nutrient dosing pumps, inline tanks, and EC/pH controllers.*

Desalination & Brackish Water Treatment

1. *Reverse osmosis (RO) systems producing farm-grade water.*
2. *Solar-powered desalination solutions for off-grid farms.*

Wastewater Reuse

1. *Farm-scale wastewater treatment plants.*
2. *Reuse of grey water for irrigation.*

Pump & Control Systems

1. *Pumps, valves, and telemetry systems.*
2. *Remote monitoring to optimize water flow.*

- **AgriTech & Automation (IoT, Robotics, AI, Drones, Fintech, Traceability)**

Farm Management Systems (FMS)

1. *Digital ERP for farms (monitoring, planning, reporting).*
2. *Decision-support systems using AI for yield and pest prediction.*

IoT & Sensors

1. *Soil moisture probes, microclimate sensors, livestock collars.*
2. *Data loggers for real-time monitoring.*

Robotics

1. *Harvesting robots (for fruits, tomatoes, lettuce).*
2. *Weeding robots reducing herbicide use.*
3. *Autonomous tractors for large farms.*

Drones & Imaging

1. *UAVs for aerial mapping, spraying pesticides/fertiliser.*
2. *Multispectral imaging for crop health assessment.*
3. *Satellite-based analytics for large-scale monitoring.*

Traceability & QA

1. *Blockchain solutions linking farm-to-fork.*
2. *Cold-chain monitoring sensors for exports.*
3. *Compliance systems for export (halal, ISO).*

Agri-Fintech

1. *Platforms offering loans, input credit, and crop insurance.*
2. *Farmer marketplaces for produce sales.*

Predictive Analytics & AI

1. *Tools for yield forecasting.*
2. *Climate-data driven risk management.*

• Supply Chain, Cold Chain & Processing

Cold Chain

1. *Cold rooms, refrigerated transport, reefer containers.*
2. *Temperature monitoring solutions (IoT-enabled).*

Packhouses & Processing

1. *Sorting and grading machines for fruits/vegetables.*
2. *Washing and packing lines.*
3. *Processing plants (juices, dairy, frozen vegetables, seafood).*

Packaging Solutions

1. *MAP (Modified Atmosphere Packaging) to extend shelf life.*
2. *Eco-friendly biodegradable packaging.*
3. *Shelf-life extension coatings.*

Logistics & Trade

1. *Freight forwarders, warehousing, free zones.*
2. *Ports and airports (AD Ports, Etihad Cargo) offering agri-logistics hubs.*

QA & Compliance

1. *Labs offering food safety testing.*
2. *Certification providers (halal, ISO, HACCP).*

Retail & HORECA Procurement

1. *Supermarkets (Carrefour, Lulu, Spinneys).*
2. *Hotel chains, restaurant groups, caterers.*

E-Commerce Food Platforms

1. *Online grocery platforms.*
2. *Farm-to-consumer delivery services.*

- **Producers (Vertical Farms, Greenhouses, Aquaculture, Livestock Integrators)**

Vertical/Indoor Farms

1. *Hydroponics: growing in water-based solutions.*
2. *Aeroponics: growing in misted air.*
3. *Controlled Environment Agriculture (CEA): tech-driven indoor farming.*
4. *Smart greenhouses with climate control systems.*

Open-Field Commercial Farms

1. *Vegetable farms (tomatoes, cucumbers, leafy greens).*
2. *Fruit orchards (dates, citrus, grapes).*
3. *Cereal farms (wheat, barley, maize).*

Aquaculture

1. *Fish farms (tilapia, seabass, catfish).*
2. *Shrimp farms (whiteleg shrimp, tiger prawns).*
3. *Recirculating Aquaculture Systems (RAS) for water efficiency.*

Livestock

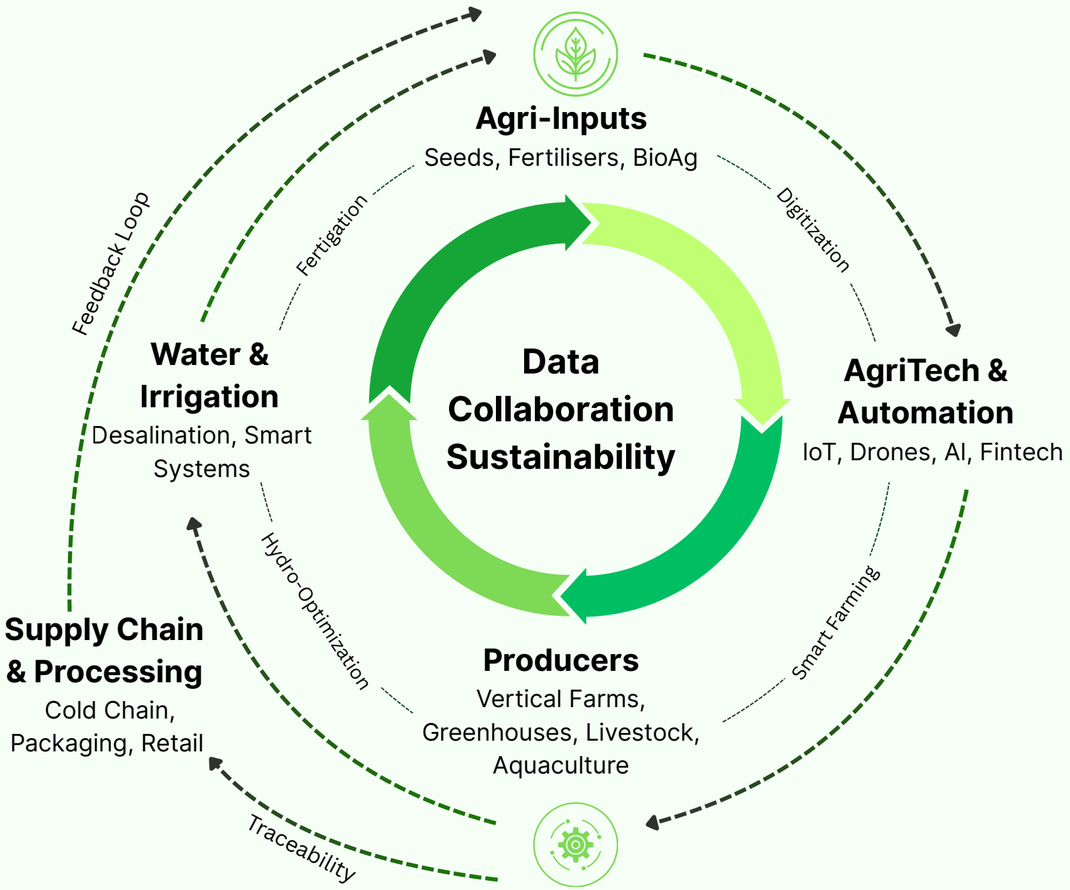
1. *Broiler/poultry integrators (chicken farms).*
2. *Dairy farms (milk, cheese, yoghurt producers).*
3. *Feedlot operators for cattle.*
4. *Fodder growers (alfalfa, sorghum).*

Integrated Operators

1. *Farm-to-retail groups (who own production + retail).*
2. *Agribusiness conglomerates (UAE-based, GCC-focused).*
3. *Institutional/government farms (e.g., ADAFSA-backed).*

THE INTERCONNECTED AGRI-FOOD ECOSYSTEM

The global agri-food system is not linear, it's a connected network where innovation, data, and sustainability flow in every direction. This ecosystem illustrates how each sector strengthens the next:



1. ***Agri-Inputs*** *provide the foundation with advanced seeds, fertilisers, and bio-solutions.*
2. ***Water & Irrigation*** *enable precision and sustainability in resource use.*
3. ***AgriTech & Automation*** *drive intelligence through IoT, AI, and drones.*
4. ***Producers*** *transform innovation into real-world productivity.*
5. ***Supply Chain & Processing*** *ensure traceability, cold chain efficiency, and safe delivery to consumers.*

Together, these pillars form a ***circular ecosystem,*** *where insights and feedback continually refine the system creating a smarter, more resilient, and sustainable food future.*
At its core: *Data | Collaboration | Sustainability.*

AGENDA DAY 1

6TH MAY 2026 (WEDNESDAY)

9:00 AM-9:15 AM	Inauguration ceremony
9:15 AM-9:30 AM	Opening Remarks
9:30 AM-9:50 AM	**Standalone session**
9:50 AM-10:30 AM	**Panel Discussion: Next-Gen Seeds: Hybrid, CRISPR and Climate-Resilient Crops** • Exploring how hybrid and CRISPR-driven seed innovations are boosting yield, resilience, and adaptability for farmers worldwide. • Understanding the rise of climate-resilient seeds designed to withstand heat, drought, salinity, and emerging environmental stresses.

10:30 AM-11:10 AM	**Panel Discussion: Sustainable Fertilization & Soil Health: From NPK to Nano and Bio** • Exploring how nano, biofertilisers, and controlled-release nutrients improve efficiency and reduce environmental impact. • Understanding soil microbiome boosters that enhance fertility, structure, and long-term regenerative health.	
11:10 AM-11:50 AM	**Panel Discussion: Modern Crop Protection: Biopesticides and Integrated Pest Management** • Highlighting sustainable pest control through biopesticides, pheromone traps, and targeted seed treatments. • Demonstrating how IPM blends cultural, biological, and safe chemical practices to reduce resistance and crop losses.	**Gaurav Sharma** - Global Agribusiness Research Lead, Growth Markets Chemicals Research Lead, Growth & Strategy- Accenture
11:50 AM - 12:00 PM Networking Break		

12:00 PM-12:40 PM	**Panel Discussion: Data-Driven Agriculture: IoT-Enabled Farm Management Systems** • Showing how IoT sensors, FMS platforms, and AI analytics support smarter decisions and early problem detection. • Detailing how real-time data improves yield, reduces input waste, and modernizes both small and large farms.	
12:40 PM-01:20 PM	**Panel Discussion: Investing in the Future of Food — AgriTech, BioAg & Climate-Smart Returns** • Exploring high-growth investment opportunities across AgriTech, automation, and biological inputs. • Discussing ROI, risk, and climate-aligned strategies attracting global and GCC-focused investors.	**Daniel Hill** - Co-Founder AQUIVIO **Bernard Sleijster** - CEO of Food Security Capital. **Shwetha Joshi -** Program Director at DEHAT
01:20 PM-01:40 PM	**Standalone session: Feeding 10 Billion: An Impossible Task Without Robotic Fleets and its infrastructure**	**Dr. Uzi Mor -** Founder & CEO of RobotPicker Ltd
01:40 PM-02:30 PM Networking Lunch		

02:30 PM-03:30 PM	Startup pitch ceremony	
03:30 PM-04:10 PM	**Panel Discussion: Automation on the Field: Agricultural Robotics and Drones** • Demonstrating how robots, UAVs, and autonomous machinery reduce labor pressure and increase precision. • Showing how imaging, spraying drones, and smart robotics support scalability in modern food production.	
04:10 PM-04:50 PM	**Panel Discussion: Agri-Fintech and Marketplaces: Empowering Farmers through Digital Platforms** • Highlighting digital tools that offer credit, insurance, and transparent payments for farmers. • Exploring blockchain, traceability, and online marketplaces linking producers directly to buyers.	**Emmanuel T.** CEO and Co-founder Everlend
04:50PM-05:30 PM	**Panel Discussion: Water for Agriculture: Desalination and Wastewater Reuse Solutions** • Examining new technologies in desalination and treated wastewater for irrigation in arid regions. • Exploring infrastructure, cost, and policy models enabling alternative water sources for farms.	**Darrin Dow** President & CEO, Motion Ag Ai, Inc.

AGENDA DAY 2

7TH MAY 2026 (THURSDAY)

9:15AM-9:30 AM	Opening Remarks	
09:30 AM-10:10 AM	**Panel Discussion: Precision Irrigation & Fertigation: Maximizing Water Use Efficiency** • Showcasing drip, micro-irrigation, and automated systems that optimize water and nutrient delivery. • Highlighting fertigation tools and sensor-based scheduling that boost yield with minimal waste.	
10:10 AM-10:50 AM	**Panel Discussion: Cold Chain and Packaging: Preserving Quality from Farm to Table** • Covering modern cold storage, reefer transport, and IoT monitoring that protect freshness. • Exploring innovative packaging like MAP and edible coatings that extend shelf life and reduce losses.	**Warmate Jones Idikio** - Founder at THE AFCFTA

10:50 AM-11:30 AM	**Panel Discussion: Food Processing and Value Addition: From Harvest to High-Value Products** • Focusing on processing technologies that convert raw produce into stable, profitable products. • Highlighting packhouses, grading lines, and advanced methods that reduce waste and increase export value.	**Grant Smith** Chief Executive Officer at BioGiene Services Pty Limited
11:30 AM-11:50 AM	**Standalone session**	
11:50 AM - 12:00 PM Networking Break		
12:00 PM-12:40 PM	**Panel Discussion: Agri-Logistics and Market Access: Connecting Producers to Consumers** • Examining logistics hubs, warehousing, and digital supply chains improving agri-movement efficiency. • Exploring how traceability, certification, and e-commerce platforms expand market reach globally.	**Filipe Ribeiro** Group Internal Audit Manager - Al Dahra

12:40 PM-01:20 PM	**Panel Discussion: Capital Meets Cultivation — Financing Food Security and Sustainable Growth** • Bringing together investors exploring bankable projects across water, tech, inputs, and production. • Highlighting blended finance, sovereign initiatives, and long-term funding models for resilient food systems.	**Bella GWON** - CEO & Founder of AgUni
01:20 PM-01:40PM	**Standalone session:**	
01:40 PM-02:30 PM Networking Lunch break		
02:30 PM-03:10 PM	**Panel Discussion: Indoor and Vertical Farming: Controlled Environment Agriculture** • Exploring hydroponic, aeroponic, and high-tech greenhouse systems enabling year-round production. • Highlighting efficiency gains through automation, lighting science, and climate-controlled farming.	**Sepehr A. Achard -** COO / Co-Founder - iGrow News **Sky Kurtz -** Founder & CEO- Pure Harvest Smart Farms

03:10 PM-03:50 PM	**Panel Discussion: Blue Revolution: Aquaculture and Sustainable Fisheries** • Examining modern fish and shrimp farming systems, from RAS to offshore aquaculture models. • Highlighting sustainability, feed innovation, and investment opportunities in scalable protein production.
03:50 PM-04:10 PM	**Standalone session**
04:10 PM-04:50 PM	**Panel Discussion: Next-Gen Livestock & Dairy: Innovations in Animal Agriculture** • Exploring smart barns, precision feeding, and genetic advances improving herd performance. • Highlighting sustainability through alternative feeds, methane reduction tools, and modern animal welfare.
04-50 PM-5:30 PM	**Award Ceremony**

THANK YOU

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